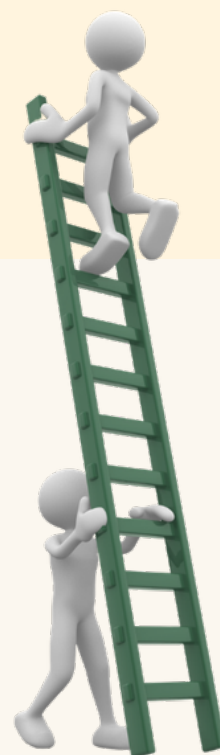


English Ladder

Student Workbook

Few and Little with/without "a"

A polished self-study handout designed for print or tablet use. Read the concept, notice the pattern, and then complete the matching practice set on your own.



Grammar Concepts #	Key Points	Usage of "Few" and "A F	Usage of "Little" and "A L	Detailed Examples and Contexts
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Visual anchor

Use the concept poster to spotlight the main language pattern in **Few and Little with/without "a"** and keep the explanation visible during practice and discussion.

ENGLISH LADDER

Concept 27 ► Few & Little with/without "a"

Sometimes a single word can completely change the meaning of a sentence. Consider the inclusion or exclusion of **a** in the sentences in the green section.

 It's enough!	 It's not enough!
I have a few opportunities to speak English, so I am learning English faster than I expected.	I have few opportunities to speak English, so I am not learning English as fast as I expected.
I have a little cash, so I can buy lunch today.	I have little cash, so I cannot buy lunch today.

The word **"few"** is used with countable nouns while **"little"** is used with uncountable nouns.

a few	few	◀ Countable
a little	little	◀ Uncountable

When we think the amount is enough, we include the word **"a"** before **"few"** and **"little"**, but not when we think the amount is insufficient to do what we want.

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Core Idea

The words few and little can drastically change the meaning of a sentence based on their inclusion or exclusion of the article "a." Understanding how to use these words correctly is crucial for conveying the right amount or quantity.

Quick reference

Countable vs. Uncountable Nouns	Few is used with countable nouns.
Countable vs. Uncountable Nouns	Apples, books, opportunities, cars.
Countable vs. Uncountable Nouns	Water, money, advice, information.

Key Points

Countable vs. Uncountable Nouns

- Few is used with countable nouns.
- Little is used with uncountable nouns.

Example of Countable Nouns:

- Apples, books, opportunities, cars.

Example of Uncountable Nouns:

- Water, money, advice, information.

Usage of "Few" and "A Few"

A Few

- Indicates a small number of countable items that is enough for a particular purpose.
- Example Sentences: I have a few friends in the city, so I am not lonely. She brought a few cookies to the party, which was enough for everyone. There are a few seats available, so we can still get tickets for the concert.

Few

- Indicates a small number of countable items that is not enough for a particular purpose.
- Example Sentences: I have few friends in the city, so I feel lonely. She brought few cookies to the party, which was not enough for everyone. There are few seats available, so we might not get tickets for the concert.



Usage of "Little" and "A Little"

A Little

- Indicates a small amount of uncountable items that is enough for a particular purpose.
- Example Sentences: I have a little money, so I can buy lunch today. There is a little water left in the bottle, enough to quench my thirst. She has a little time before the meeting, so she can review her notes.

Little

- Indicates a small amount of uncountable items that is not enough for a particular purpose.
- Example Sentences: I have little money, so I cannot buy lunch today. There is little water left in the bottle, not enough to quench my thirst. She has little time before the meeting, so she cannot review her notes.

Detailed Examples and Contexts

Countable Nouns

Context: Speaking about job opportunities.

- A Few Opportunities: "I have a few opportunities to speak English, so I am learning faster than I expected."
Meaning: There are enough opportunities to help me learn English effectively.
- Few Opportunities: "I have few opportunities to speak English, so I am not learning as fast as I expected."
Meaning: There are not enough opportunities to help me learn English effectively.

Uncountable Nouns

Context: Talking about cash or money.

- A Little Cash: "I have a little cash, so I can buy lunch today." Meaning: The amount of cash I have is enough for buying lunch.
- Little Cash: "I have little cash, so I cannot buy lunch today." Meaning: The amount of cash I have is not enough for buying lunch.

Grammar Summary

- Use a few with countable nouns to indicate a small but sufficient number.
- Use few with countable nouns to indicate a small and insufficient number.
- Use a little with uncountable nouns to indicate a small but sufficient amount.
- Use little with uncountable nouns to indicate a small and insufficient amount.

Additional Practice



To further solidify understanding, here are more example sentences with varied contexts:

Countable Nouns:

- A Few: "He answered a few questions correctly on the test, so he passed." "They received a few donations, which helped cover the costs."
- Few: "He answered few questions correctly on the test, so he failed." "They received few donations, which were not enough to cover the costs."

Uncountable Nouns:

- A Little: "There is a little sugar in the jar, enough for my coffee." "I have a little information about the topic, so I can participate in the discussion."
- Little: "There is little sugar in the jar, not enough for my coffee." "I have little information about the topic, so I cannot participate in the discussion."

Understanding the correct usage of few, a few, little, and a little is essential for accurate communication in English. Using these words appropriately will help convey the intended meaning and improve overall language proficiency.

Few and Little with/without "a"

Concept Explanation

The words few and little can drastically change the meaning of a sentence based on their inclusion or exclusion of the article "a." Understanding how to use these words correctly is crucial for conveying the right amount or quantity.

Countable vs. Uncountable Nouns

- Few is used with countable nouns.
- Little is used with uncountable nouns.

Examples of Countable Nouns:

- Apples, books, opportunities, cars.

Examples of Uncountable Nouns:

- Water, money, advice, information.

Usage of "Few" and "A Few"

A Few

- Definition: "A few" indicates a small number of countable items that is enough for a particular purpose.
- Examples: "I have a few friends in the city, so I am not lonely." ■ "She brought a few cookies to the party, which was enough for everyone." ■ "There are a few seats available, so we can still get tickets for the concert." ■



Few

- Definition: "Few" indicates a small number of countable items that is not enough for a particular purpose.
- Examples: "I have few friends in the city, so I feel lonely." ■ "She brought few cookies to the party, which was not enough for everyone." ■ "There are few seats available, so we might not get tickets for the concert." ■

Usage of "Little" and "A Little"

A Little

- Definition: "A little" indicates a small amount of uncountable items that is enough for a particular purpose.
- Examples: "I have a little money, so I can buy lunch today." ■ "There is a little water left in the bottle, enough to quench my thirst." ■ "She has a little time before the meeting, so she can review her notes." ■

Little

- Definition: "Little" indicates a small amount of uncountable items that is not enough for a particular purpose.
- Examples: "I have little money, so I cannot buy lunch today." ■ "There is little water left in the bottle, not enough to quench my thirst." ■ "She has little time before the meeting, so she cannot review her notes." ■

Detailed Examples and Contexts

Countable Nouns

Context: Speaking about job opportunities.

- A Few Opportunities: "I have a few opportunities to speak English, so I am learning faster than I expected." ■
Meaning: There are enough opportunities to help me learn English effectively.
- Few Opportunities: "I have few opportunities to speak English, so I am not learning as fast as I expected." ■
Meaning: There are not enough opportunities to help me learn English effectively.

Uncountable Nouns

Context: Talking about cash or money.

- A Little Cash: "I have a little cash, so I can buy lunch today." ■ Meaning: The amount of cash I have is enough for buying lunch.
- Little Cash: "I have little cash, so I cannot buy lunch today." ■ Meaning: The amount of cash I have is not enough for buying lunch.

Grammar Summary

- A Few: Use with countable nouns to indicate a small but sufficient number.
- Few: Use with countable nouns to indicate a small and insufficient number.



- A Little: Use with uncountable nouns to indicate a small but sufficient amount.
- Little: Use with uncountable nouns to indicate a small and insufficient amount.

Additional Practice

To further solidify understanding, here are more example sentences with varied contexts:

Countable Nouns:

- A Few: "He answered a few questions correctly on the test, so he passed." ■ "They received a few donations, which helped cover the costs." ■
- Few: "He answered few questions correctly on the test, so he failed." ■ "They received few donations, which were not enough to cover the costs." ■

Uncountable Nouns:

- A Little: "There is a little sugar in the jar, enough for my coffee." ■ "I have a little information about the topic, so I can participate in the discussion." ■
- Little: "There is little sugar in the jar, not enough for my coffee." ■ "I have little information about the topic, so I cannot participate in the discussion." ■

Understanding the correct usage of few, a few, little, and a little is essential for accurate communication in English. Using these words appropriately will help convey the intended meaning and improve overall language proficiency.



Practice Check

Answer the quiz questions below with responses consistent with the grammar concepts taught in this article.

ITEM 01

I have _____ friends in the city, so I am not lonely.

a) few

b) a few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 02

There is _____ water left in the bottle, not enough to quench my thirst.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 03

She has _____ money, so she can buy lunch today.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 04

He answered _____ questions correctly on the test, so he passed.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 05**

I have _____ opportunities to speak English, so I am learning faster than I expected.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 06

There are _____ seats available, so we might not get tickets for the concert.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 07

I have _____ opportunities to speak English, so I am not learning as fast as I expected.

a) few

b) a few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 08

I have _____ cash, so I cannot buy lunch today.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 09**

I have _____ money, so I cannot buy lunch today.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 10

She has _____ friends, so she feels lonely.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 11

She brought _____ cookies to the party, which was not enough for everyone.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 12

She brought _____ cookies to the party, which was enough for everyone.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 13**

There is _____ information available to make a decision.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 14

There is _____ water in the glass, enough to fill the cup.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 15

There is _____ milk in the fridge, not enough for cereal.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 16

She has _____ patience left after dealing with the kids all day.

a) little

b) a little

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 17**

He gave _____ effort in the project, resulting in poor outcomes.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 18

He put in _____ effort in the project, leading to its success.

a) little

b) a little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 19

He gave _____ of his time to help with the project, which was appreciated.

a) a little

b) little

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 20

There are _____ apples in the basket, not enough for everyone.

a) a few

b) few

Correct choice: _____

**ITEM 21**

There are _____ apples in the basket, enough for everyone.

a) few

b) a few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 22

He received _____ invitations, so he is not sure which party to attend.

a) few

b) a few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 23

He received _____ invitations, so he is sure which party to attend.

a) few

b) a few

Correct choice: _____

ITEM 24

He has _____ friends to help him move, so he is worried.

a) few

b) a few

Correct choice: _____



Self-check Answer Key

Use the key after you have completed every item on your own.

Item 01 The correct answer is b) a few. "A few" indicates a small but sufficient number of friends. "Few" would indicate not enough friends to avoid loneliness.

Item 02 The correct answer is b) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount to quench thirst.

Item 03 The correct answer is a) a little. "A little" indicates a small but sufficient amount of money. "Little" would indicate not enough money to buy lunch.

Item 04 The correct answer is a) a few. "A few" indicates enough correct answers to pass. "Few" would indicate not enough correct answers to pass.

Item 05 The correct answer is a) a few. "A few" indicates a sufficient number of opportunities. "Few" would indicate not enough opportunities to learn faster.

Item 06 The correct answer is b) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of seats. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of seats.

Item 07 The correct answer is a) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of opportunities. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of opportunities to learn faster.

Item 08 The correct answer is b) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount of cash. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount of cash to buy lunch.

Item 09 The correct answer is b) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount of money. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount of money to buy lunch.

Item 10 The correct answer is b) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of friends. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of friends to avoid loneliness.

Item 11 The correct answer is b) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of cookies. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of cookies for everyone.

Item 12 The correct answer is a) a few. "A few" indicates a sufficient number of cookies. "Few" would indicate not enough cookies for everyone.

Item 13 The correct answer is b) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount of information. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount of information.

Item 14 The correct answer is a) a little. "A little" indicates a sufficient amount of water. "Little" would indicate not enough water to fill the cup.



Item 15 The correct answer is b) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount of milk. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount of milk for cereal.

Item 16 The correct answer is a) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount of patience. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount of patience.

Item 17 The correct answer is b) little. "Little" indicates an insufficient amount of effort. "A little" would indicate a sufficient amount of effort.

Item 18 The correct answer is b) a little. "A little" indicates a sufficient amount of effort. "Little" would indicate an insufficient amount of effort.

Item 19 The correct answer is a) a little. "A little" indicates a sufficient amount of time. "Little" would indicate an insufficient amount of time.

Item 20 The correct answer is b) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of apples. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of apples for everyone.

Item 21 The correct answer is b) a few. "A few" indicates a sufficient number of apples. "Few" would indicate not enough apples for everyone.

Item 22 The correct answer is b) a few. "A few" indicates a sufficient number of invitations. "Few" would indicate not enough invitations to be unsure.

Item 23 The correct answer is a) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of invitations. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of invitations to be unsure.

Item 24 The correct answer is a) few. "Few" indicates an insufficient number of friends. "A few" would indicate a sufficient number of friends to help him move.
